

Skills Summary

Naming Shapes Any Way They Turn

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Count the sides and corners

Rule: A shape's name comes from counting.

- triangle: 3 straight sides
- square and rectangle: 4
- hexagon: 6 straight sides
- sides and corners always match!

Example: How many sides and corners does a square have?

Step 1. Trace the shape with a finger — count each straight side, then each place where two sides meet.

Step 2. A square has 4 straight sides, and the sides meet 4 times.

⇒ a square has **4** sides and 4 corners

Try it: How many corners does a triangle have?

check: 3

A turned shape keeps its name

Rule: Turning, tilting, or flipping a shape never changes its name. The name lives in the sides and corners — and turning changes neither.

Example: A square is tilted to stand on one corner. How many sides does it have now?

Step 1. Turning moves the shape but keeps every side and corner — so count just as before.

Step 2. The four sides are all still there: count 4.

⇒ still **4** sides — still a square!

Try it: A triangle is flipped upside down. How many corners does it have now?

check: 3 — still a triangle

(!) Watch out: A tilted square is NOT a new shape called a “diamond.” Before renaming a shape, count its sides and corners — if nothing changed, the name did not change either.

Compare shapes by counting

Rule: To compare two shapes, count the same thing on both (sides or corners), then subtract the counts.

Example: How many more sides does a hexagon have than a triangle?

Step 1. Count sides on each shape first, then find the difference.

Step 2. Hexagon: 6 sides. Triangle: 3 sides. $6 - 3 = 3$.

⇒ the hexagon has **3** more sides

Try it: How many more sides does a square have than a triangle?

check: 1